You build up the middleware pipeline in ASP.NET Core by calling methods on `WebApplication` (which implements `IApplicationBuilder`). `WebApplication` doesn't define methods like `UseWelcomePage` itself; instead, these are *extension* methods.

Using extension methods allows you to add functionality to the `WebApplication` class, while keeping the implementation isolated from it. Under the hood, the methods typically call *another* extension method to add the middleware to the pipeline. Behind the scenes, for example, the `UseWelcomePage` method adds the `WelcomePageMiddleware` to the pipeline by calling

```
UseMiddleware<WelcomePageMiddleware>();
```

This convention of creating an extension method for each piece of middleware and starting the method name with `Use` is designed to improve discoverability when you add middleware to your application.[2] ASP.NET Core includes a lot of middleware as part of the core framework, so you can use IntelliSense in Visual Studio and other integrated development environments (IDEs) to view all the middleware that's available, as shown in figure 4.6.